



MY RIGHTS HANDBOOK

For Class 12 Students

✨ Dear Student,

You are now in Class 12 — ready to step into adulthood.

Very soon, you will turn 18 — the age when you become a **legal adult** under Indian law.

This means:

- ✓ You will gain new rights (like voting!).
 - ✓ You must also understand your responsibilities as an adult.
 - ✓ This handbook helps you stay safe, respected, and informed.
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Which Laws Protect You Now?

- ✓ **Constitution of India** — Article 21A (education), Article 14 & 15 (equality), Article 326 (voting rights).
 - ✓ **Juvenile Justice Act, 2015 (JJ Act)** — Protects you until you turn 18.
 - ✓ **Protection of Children from Sexual Offences Act, 2012 (POCSO Act)** — Protects you till 18 from sexual abuse.
 - ✓ **Prohibition of Child Marriage Act, 2006** — Protects girls (must be 18+) and boys (must be 21+) from child marriage.
 - ✓ **Child Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986** — Protects those under 18 from hazardous work.
 - ✓ **Apprentices Act, 1961** — Gives you the right to safe training and fair conditions if you join an apprenticeship.
 - ✓ **Information Technology Act, 2000 (amended)** — Protects you online.
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YOUR RIGHTS – EXPLAINED SIMPLY



1 Right to Complete Your Education

- ✓ **Law:** Constitution, NEP 2020

- You have the right to complete your Class 12 without discrimination.

- If you want to study further, you have the right to apply for colleges, vocational courses, or government skill training.

💡 *What you can do:* Ask your teachers or career counselor about scholarships and entrance exams.

2 Right to Safe Work & Apprenticeships

✅ **Law:** Child Labour Act & Apprentices Act

- After 18, you can work as an adult — but you still have the right to **safe, non-exploitative working conditions**.
- Before turning 18, you cannot be made to do hazardous work.
- Apprenticeships must be properly registered and pay a stipend.

💡 *What you can do:* Always get a training letter or contract. Report unsafe work.

3 Right to Vote

✅ **Law:** Constitution — Article 326, Representation of the People Act, 1950

- When you turn 18, you get the **right to vote** in elections.
- You can register on the voter list and get your **Voter ID card (EPIC)**.

💡 *What you can do:* Visit www.nvsp.in or ask your nearest Electoral Officer to apply for your Voter ID.

4 Right to Protection from Abuse

✅ **Law:** POCSO Act (till 18), IPC after that

- No one can sexually harass or abuse you.
- Once you turn 18, you have the right to **consent** — no one can force you to do anything without your free will.

💡 *What you can do:* Say **NO**, move away, report to police or call **Childline 1098** (if under 18) or Police Helpline 100.

5 Right to Equality & Choice

✅ **Law:** Constitution — Article 14 & 15

- No one can discriminate against you for your caste, religion, gender, or language.
- You have the right to make your own decisions about your career, higher education, or whom to marry (once of legal age).

💡 *What you can do:* Seek help if you face forced marriage — it's illegal for girls under 18 and boys under 21.

6 Right to Health & Privacy

✅ **Law:** Indian Medical laws, JJ Act

- You have the right to safe health care.
- Doctors must keep your health details private.
- Girls have the right to menstrual hygiene and reproductive health info.

💡 *What you can do:* Speak to health workers if you have questions about puberty, contraception, or mental health.

7 Right to Say No to Drugs & Substance Abuse

✅ **Law:** NDPS Act

- It is illegal for anyone to give you drugs, alcohol, or tobacco if you are underage.
- Anyone forcing or tricking you can be punished.

💡 *What you can do:* Report to police or **Narcotics Helpline 1800-11-0031**.

8 Right to Online Safety & Privacy

✓ **Law:** IT Act, 2000 (amended)

- You have the right to protect your private photos, messages, and data.
- Sharing intimate photos without consent is a crime.
- Online blackmail and threats are punishable.

 *What you can do:* Keep proof. Call **Cyber Crime Helpline 1930**.

9 Right to Identity Documents

✓ **Law:** Constitution, JJ Act

- You must get your **Aadhaar card**, **PAN card**, and **Voter ID** as you turn 18 — these help you vote, get jobs, or open bank accounts.

 *What you can do:* Ask your teacher or visit the local CSC (Common Service Centre) for help.

✓ Important Helpline Numbers

- ✓ **Childline:** 📞 1098 (free, 24×7, till age 18)
 - ✓ **Police:** 📞 100 or 112
 - ✓ **Women's Helpline:** 📞 181 (for girls/women)
 - ✓ **Cyber Crime Helpline:** 📞 1930
 - ✓ **Narcotics Helpline:** 📞 1800-11-0031
 - ✓ **Voter ID Help:** 📞 1950 or www.nvsp.in
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Your Responsibilities

- ✓ Respect everyone's rights.
 - ✓ Make safe choices — online and offline.
 - ✓ Register to vote — your voice matters!
 - ✓ Work safely and legally — do not let anyone exploit you.
 - ✓ Say NO to drugs, forced work, or harassment.
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REMEMBER!

-  You are protected by India's laws.
-  You have the right to vote, work, and make decisions once you are an adult.
-  You have the right to health, privacy, and safe relationships.
-  You have the power to stand up for yourself and others.